

NORWAY

LME CROCHET PATTERN

BUCKET HATS FOR BABY AND CHILD, RUNE LETTERS

NORGE · NORWAY · SIZE 50-170

The same bucket hat as the adult NORGE rune hat pattern, crocheted in single crochet and graded completely from scratch into twenty-one baby, child and teen sizes, 50 to 170. You crochet the whole hat in one colour, then crochet “NORGE” (or “NORWAY”) on at the end in readable rune-style letters, plus a small Norwegian flag on the top. This pattern is complete on its own, you do not need any other LME pattern to crochet it.



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TIPS: Read the whole pattern once before you start. Always crochet a gauge swatch first, see page 4.

BEFORE YOU START

The bucket hat is crocheted in a spiral (not joined rounds) in single crochet, from the top down, in a single colour throughout. You start with a rounded crown that grows from a small ring, then the sides straight down, and finally a brim that flares out and waves. Right at the end you crochet the letters and the flag onto the surface. This pattern covers two words, pick the one you want to make:

- **NORGE:** the word in rune-style letters, across the forehead
- **NORWAY:** the same, but with the English name

WHAT YOU LEARN

- To crochet in a spiral from a magic ring
- To increase evenly to crochet a flat, rounded top
- To crochet surface crochet: slip stitches worked on top of the hat, making raised letters
- To crochet a flared, wavy brim with an increase round

HOW HARD IS IT?

Beginner friendly. You should be able to single crochet, know a magic ring and crochet slip stitches. The hat itself is crocheted in just one colour, the letters go on afterwards with the hook right on the surface, and every step is spelled out in this pattern.

Use a stitch marker (a safety pin or a length of thread in another colour works fine) in the first stitch of every round, so you do not lose count in the spiral.

SIZES AND GETTING THE FIT RIGHT

The clothing size is only a guide. Always measure around the child's head, above the ears and eyebrows. Go by the head measurement if it and the clothing size point to different sizes.

Size	Approx. age	Head (cm)
50	0-1 mo	34-36
56	1-2 mo	36-38
62	2-4 mo	38-40
68	4-6 mo	40-42
74	6-9 mo	42-44
80	9-12 mo	44-46
86	12-18 mo	46-48
92	18-24 mo	48-50
98	2-3 yr	49-51
104	3-4 yr	50-52

SAFE USE FOR THE YOUNGEST

The hat is a garment for supervised, awake use. It should not be used during sleep, in a cot, in a pram unattended, or if the brim covers the eyes, nose or mouth. Always check that no loose threads on the inside can catch on little fingers.

Children grow at different rates. The actual head measurement always beats age, measure again whenever you are unsure.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

A smooth cotton yarn (aran weight) that gives 14 single crochet x 16 rounds = 10 x 10 cm, crocheted in a spiral. Reynolds Saucy, Rico Design Creative Cotton Aran and Hobbii Amigo are all good choices, in red and white (or whichever colour you want the letters in).

Colour

Use

● Red	main colour, whole hat
○ White	the letters and the flag
● Navy	the small cross in the flag

Have plenty of red main colour (almost the whole hat is crocheted in red) and a little white and navy, they are only used for the letters and the flag.

HOOK AND KIT

- A hook that gives the stated gauge, often 3.5–4 mm for an aran yarn
- **Tapestry needle with a blunt tip** if you sew the letters on as a cord (see page 8)
- Scissors and tape measure
- Stitch marker for the first stitch of every round

If you crochet tightly, try a bigger hook. If you crochet loosely, try a smaller hook. The target is always 14 sc over 10 cm.

GAUGE, THE IMPORTANT KEY

CROCHET A SWATCH FIRST

Crochet a square at least 12 x 12 cm in single crochet with the main colour. Wash and dry it the way you plan to treat the hat, then measure across the middle.

- More than 14 sc over 10 cm: try a bigger hook.
- Fewer than 14 sc over 10 cm: try a smaller hook.
- Exactly 14 sc: use your hook and get going.

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
sc	single crochet
rnd	round, one whole lap around
inc	increase, 2 sc in the same stitch
sl st	slip stitch
MC	main colour (red)
spiral	the rounds are crocheted in one continuous round, without a slip stitch join, follow the stitch marker
surface crochet	slip stitches worked on top of the finished hat, making raised letters

PART 1: THE TOP

- 1 Crochet 6 sc into a magic ring in red main colour. Pull the ring tight. Place a stitch marker in the first stitch, move the marker up one stitch for every new round. From now on everything is crocheted in a spiral, with no slip stitch join.
- 2 Rnd 2: inc (2 sc) in every stitch around = 12 stitches.
- 3 Rnd 3: *inc, 1 sc*, repeat around = 18 stitches.
- 4 Rnd 4: *inc, 1 sc, 1 sc*, repeat around = 24 stitches. Continue the same way: each new round increases 6 stitches evenly spaced, with one more plain sc between each increase than the round before.
- 5 Find the number for your size in the «Standard round» column in the table on the next page. Keep increasing this way until you have crocheted exactly that round.
- 6 If your size has a number other than 0 in the «Extra» column, crochet one more round: spread the given number of increases evenly around the round (for example every sixth/seventh stitch), the rest plain sc. That lands you exactly on the «Total» column number.

Check the diameter against the table on the next page, not just the stitch count. If you are more than 0.5 cm off, adjust your hook size before continuing.

TABLE: THE TOP, ALL SIZES

Size	Standard round	Extra	Total stitches	Top diam. (cm)
50	8	0	48	10.9
56	8	3	51	11.6
62	9	0	54	12.3
68	9	3	57	13.0
74	10	0	60	13.6
80	10	3	63	14.3
86	11	0	66	15.0
92	11	2	68	15.5
98	11	4	70	15.9
104	12	0	72	16.4
110	12	1	73	16.6
116	12	2	74	16.8
122	12	2	74	16.8
128	12	3	75	17.1
134	12	4	76	17.3
140	12	4	76	17.3
146	12	5	77	17.5
152	13	0	78	17.7
158	13	0	78	17.7
164	13	1	79	18.0
170	13	2	80	18.2

PART 2: THE SIDES

- 1 When the top has the right stitch count, crochet straight down with no more increases. Keep the stitch count from the table on the previous page throughout this part, this is now the sides of the hat.
- 2 Crochet the number of rounds given in the «Side rounds» column in the table below, in the main colour. Do not worry about the letters yet, you crochet those onto the surface at the end, see Part 3 on the next page.

TABLE: THE SIDES

Size	Side rounds	Height of sides (cm)
50	12	7.5
56	13	8.1
62	14	8.75
68	14	8.75
74	15	9.4
80	16	10
86	17	10.6
92	18	11.25
98	18	11.25
104	19	11.9
110	20	12.5
116	21	13.1
122	22	13.75
128	23	14.4
134	24	15
140	25	15.6
146	26	16.25
152	27	16.9
158	28	17.5
164	29	18.1
170	30	18.75

The letters are crocheted onto the surface in the middle of the sides at the end, see the table on the next page for the exact placement.

PART 3: CROCHET THE LETTERS ON

The sides are now fully crocheted, all one colour. You crochet the letters right onto the red surface with white yarn, so they stand up, just like on the adult rune hat. You can do it in two ways, pick the one you like best.

WAY 1: SURFACE CROCHET, RECOMMENDED

- 1 Hold the white yarn on the inside of the hat. Put the hook through the hat from the outside, where the letter is to begin, and pull up a white loop.
- 2 Put the hook in a little further along the line, pull up a new loop and draw it through the loop already on the hook. That is one slip stitch on the surface.
- 3 Continue slip stitch after slip stitch along all the lines of the letter, following the template on the next page. Keep the spacing even, do not pull tight.
- 4 Fasten the yarn on the inside when the letter is done, and move on to the next letter.

WAY 2: CROCHET A CORD AND SEW IT ON

Crochet a long chain in white and work a row of slip stitches back along it, so you get a firm cord. Shape the cord into each letter following the template and sew it onto the hat with white yarn and the tapestry needle. That makes the letters clear and raised.

SIZE AND PLACEMENT, ALL SIZES

Size	Letter height (cm)	Margin above/below (cm)
50	3.5	1.9
56	4	2
62	4.4	2.2
68	4.4	2.2
74	4.7	2.3
80	5	2.5
86	5.3	2.7
92	5.6	2.8
98	5.6	2.8
104	5.9	3
110	6.2	3.1
116	6.6	3.3
122	6.9	3.4
128	7.2	3.6
134	7.5	3.8
140	7.8	3.9
146	8.1	4.1
152	8.4	4.2
158	8.8	4.3
164	9.1	4.5
170	9.4	4.7

Tip: draw the letters lightly with a water-soluble marker or place pins first, so you hit the shape.

THE LETTER TEMPLATE AND THE FLAG

Here are the letters in rune style. Crochet them on in one continuous line, centred at the front, with the bottom of the letters in the middle of the sides' height (see the table on the previous page).

The template is shown upside down, because the hat is crocheted from the top down. Follow the letters as they appear here, and they will come out the right way on the finished hat.

NORGE

NORGE

NORWAY

NORWAY

THE FLAG ON THE TOP



- Find the middle of the top where the magic ring was. Make a white cross with surface crochet or a sewn cord: one arm forward, one back and one to each side.
- Then make a blue cross on top of the middle of the white, a little narrower, so the white shows around the blue.
- Fasten all ends well on the inside.

PART 4: THE BRIM

- 1 Switch to white (or keep red if you want a solid-colour brim).
- 2 Crochet one round with no increase in the new colour.
- 3 Find the «Increase on rnd» column in the table on the next page. On each of these round numbers (counted from the start of the brim) you spread the number of increases from the «Increases each time» column evenly around the round. On the rounds in between you crochet one plain sc in every stitch.
- 4 Continue until the brim has been crocheted for the number of rounds in the «Brim rnds» column. The final result will be about the number in the «Approx. finish» column.

TABLE: THE BRIM, ALL SIZES

Size	Brim rnds	Increase on rnd	Increases each time	Approx. finish (st)
50	6	2, 4, 6	6	66
56	6	2, 4, 6	6	69
62	7	2, 4, 6	7	75
68	7	2, 4, 6	7	78
74	8	2, 4, 6, 8	8	92
80	8	2, 4, 6, 8	8	95
86	9	2, 4, 6, 8	8	98
92	9	2, 4, 6, 8	9	104
98	10	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	9	115
104	10	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	9	117
110	11	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	9	119
116	11	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	9	120
122	12	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	10	120
128	12	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	10	122
134	13	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	10	124
140	13	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	11	124
146	14	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	11	125
152	14	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	11	127
158	15	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	12	127
164	15	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	12	128
170	16	2, 4, 6, 8, 10	12	130

THE WAVY FINISH

For a gentle wave: finish with slip stitches or reverse single crochet (crab stitch). For a more pronounced wave: *3 sc in the next stitch, 1 sc, skip 2 stitches*, repeat around. For the smallest sizes (50–68) the gentle finish is recommended, so the brim does not hang heavy in front of the face.

CARE AND FINAL CHECK

FINISHING

Cut the yarn leaving a generous tail and fasten it well on the inside. Weave in all loose ends, especially around the letters and the flag.

CARE

Wash following the yarn's recommendation, often 30°C on a gentle cycle in a wash bag, or by hand. Do not tumble dry. Shape the hat over a bowl or glass of the right size and let it dry flat or on the form.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ The head measurement has been checked, not just age
- ☐ The swatch matches 14 sc x 16 rounds over 10 cm
- ☐ The top's diameter matches the table on page 7
- ☐ The letters are crocheted on at centre front, centred
- ☐ The little flag sits on the top
- ☐ The brim is crocheted for the stated number of rounds and has the shape from the table

Congratulations, you have crocheted your very own kids' rune-letter bucket hat!



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The hat is a garment for supervised, awake use. Do not use during sleep or in a pram unattended.